

PARENT HANDBOOK FOR PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

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PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: WELCOME

POLICY NO.: 1

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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Welcome to Play Academy.

This handbook contains information regarding our program. You must read this handbook and keep it handy or view it online as long as your child is enrolled in the Center. It will answer many questions you have about Play Academy.

1.1 PROGRAM PHILOSOPHY:

Play Academy is an educational program established to provide quality education and loving care for children between 6 weeks and 12 years old. Celebration of diversity is a big part of our program because it helps children and families strengthen their own identity and values. Our educational goal is to help children blossom emotionally and intellectually at their own pace in areas that interest them. Children who play, create, and explore in a safe, supportive, and nurturing environment discover a love of learning. We are pleased that you have chosen to include us in the growth and development of your children because we are here to create that special place for them where learning is fun.

1.2 MISSION STATEMENT:

- To provide a comprehensive early childhood education program and complete childcare services for young children, the curriculum shall be designed to enhance the total development of each child
- To meet the needs of all children, including those at risk, those with special needs, those who are gifted, and those who are culturally diverse.
- To advocate developmentally appropriate, child-centered, active, experiential learning through play and positive experience.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: LICENSING/CONTACT INFORMATION

POLICY NO.: 2

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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2.1 LICENSING INFORMATION:

Play Academy is licensed to operate legally by the Ohio Department of Job and Family Services. This license is posted in the reception area for review.

License #300629

2.2 ACCREDITATION INFORMATION:

The State of Ohio has awarded this program a Gold Rating for meeting the quality standards established by the Ohio Department of Children and Youth.

2.3 CONTACT INFORMATION:

Address: 6285 Pearl Rd #30, Parma Heights, Ohio, 44130

Phone: (440) 884-7529

Fax: (440) 743-7529

Email: playacademy2@gmail.com

Website: www.playacademyusa.com

Administrator - Cynthia Patsko

Director - Tatiana Kogan

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: ENROLLMENT

POLICY NO.: 3

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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Enrollment at Play Academy is open to children from 6 weeks to 12 years of age. Enrollment shall be granted without regard to a child's race, color, creed, religion, national origin, gender, or disability and to a parent or guardian's race, color, creed, religion, age, national origin, gender, pregnancy, or disability.

Parents can apply for their child's enrollment in Play Academy by completing the Enrollment Fee Agreement and paying the \$75 Application Fee (per family). The Application Fee is non-refundable.

Initial enrollment is contingent upon receipt of the completed and signed fee agreement, registration fee, administration of medication form and care plan (if applicable), medical statement, and signed Parent Handbook receipt.

The Enrollment Application and Fee Agreements are not meant to serve as contracts guaranteeing service for any duration.

Play Academy reserves the right to dismiss any parent or child at any time, with or without cause.

Continued enrollment at Play Academy is contingent upon the parent, emergency contact persons, and child's adherence to Play Academy's policies and procedures as outlined in this handbook, including, but not limited to, timely payment of all fees and tuition.

Parents must notify Play Academy immediately should any information collected at enrollment or any time thereafter change. Failure to do so may result in the child(ren) being disenrolled from the program.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: TUITION

POLICY NO.: 4

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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All custodial parents and/or legal guardians must sign a Fee Agreement before enrolling their child in Play Academy. Parents must indicate to whom all billing information and correspondence must be addressed.

4.1 PAYMENT SCHEDULE:

The tuition is due at least one week in advance. You will be billed through the Brightwheel app on Friday and must be paid no later than Monday. Automatic withdrawal is available at no cost to you, and it is strongly recommended to avoid late fees.

Cash, check, money order, or credit card may pay tuition. Play Academy accepts credit cards through the Brightwheel app. Receipts for tuition payments by cash or credit card will be sent through the Brightwheel app. All cash payments must be handed directly to the Administrator, Center Director, or Assistant Center Director. Let them know if you would like a printed receipt. Your canceled check will serve as your receipt for payments made by check. A \$35 fee will be charged for tuition checks returned by the bank. Returned Tuition checks will not be re-deposited. Parents will be responsible for re-issuing a second check. If, at any future time, the bank returns a parent's check, all future tuition payments must be made by cash, certified check, money order, or credit card.

4.2 LATE PAYMENTS:

If tuition payment is not received by Monday, a daily fee of \$5 will be charged to the account, up to \$25 per week.

No credit is given for vacations, scheduled school holidays, child illness, or closings due to emergencies, inclement weather, or acts of God.

Non-payment of tuition is grounds for immediate dismissal from the program. Timely payments are essential for continued enrollment at Play Academy; however, if you anticipate difficulty paying on time, please immediately discuss the matter with the Center Director. If alternative payment arrangements are approved, the Center Director will notify you.

4.3 SUBSIDIZED CARE:

Play Academy accepts childcare subsidies.

Parents of a subsidized child must complete all required paperwork on time to continue enrollment at Play Academy. They must also sign a fee agreement, agreeing to be personally responsible for paying any assigned co-pays and tuition payments if they become ineligible to receive childcare subsidies.

4.4 UPK PROGRAM:

UPK parent scholarships are available for families living in Cuyahoga County with incomes up to 400% of the federal poverty level. Scholarships are determined based on the fee the family pays and their gross income. Children age 3 through 5 are eligible to participate in the program.

4.5 MULTIPLE CHILD DISCOUNT:

Play Academy offers a multiple-child discount for one or more siblings enrolled during the same school year (full-time tuition only). The youngest sibling pays the full tuition rate, and each additional child's tuition is discounted by 10 percent per child. Discounts are only applicable when tuition payments are made on time. The full tuition rate, plus any additional late fees, will be charged when tuition payments are late as per the late tuition policy stated above.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: CONFIDENTIALITY

POLICY NO.: 5

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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Within Play Academy, confidential and sensitive information will only be shared with employees of Play Academy who have a "need to know" to most appropriately and safely care for your child. Confidential and sensitive information about faculty, other parents, and/or children will not be shared with parents, as Play Academy strives to protect everyone's right to privacy. Confidential information includes but is not limited to names, addresses, phone numbers, disability information, HIV/AIDS status, or other health-related information of anyone associated with Play Academy.

Confidential and sensitive information about a child will only be shared outside of Play Academy with the parents' express written consent, except where otherwise provided for by law. Parents will be provided with a document detailing the information to be shared outside of Play Academy, the persons with whom the information will be shared, and the reason(s) for sharing the information.

Any parent who violates the Confidentiality policy will not be permitted on agency property thereafter. Refer to the Parent's Right to Immediate Access policy for additional information regarding the dis-enrollment of a child when a parent is prohibited from accessing agency property.

You may observe children at our center who are disabled or who exhibit behavior that may appear inappropriate (i.e., biting, hitting, and spitting). You may be curious or concerned about the other child. Our Confidentiality Policy protects every child's privacy. Employees of Play Academy are strictly prohibited from discussing anything about another child with you.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: REPORTING OF CHILD ABUSE AND NEGLECT

POLICY NO.: 6

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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Under the Child Protective Services Act, mandated reporters must report any suspicion of abuse or neglect to the appropriate authorities. The employees of Play Academy are considered mandated reporters under this law. The employees of Play Academy are not required to discuss their suspicions with parents before reporting the matter to the appropriate authorities, nor are they needed to investigate the cause of any suspicious marks, behavior, or condition before making a report. Under the Act, mandated reporters can be held criminally responsible if they fail to report suspected abuse or neglect. We at Play Academy take this responsibility very seriously and will make all warranted reports to the appropriate authorities. The Child Protective Services Act is designed to protect all children's welfare and best interests.

As mandated reporters, the staff of Play Academy cannot be held liable for unfounded reports made to Child Protective Services, provided the report was made in "good faith."

Causes for reporting suspected child abuse or neglect include, but are not limited to:

- ◆ Unusual bruising, marks, or cuts on the child's body
- ◆ Severe verbal reprimands
- ◆ Improper clothing relating to size, cleanliness, season
- ◆ Transporting a child without appropriate child restraints (e.g., car seats, seat belts, etc.)
- ◆ Dropping off or picking up a child while under the influence of illegal drugs or alcohol
- ◆ Not providing appropriate meals, including a drink for your child
- ◆ Leaving a child unattended for any amount of time
- ◆ Failure to attend to the special needs of a disabled child
- ◆ Sending a sick child to school is overmedicated, hiding symptoms, which would typically require the child to be kept at home until symptoms subside.
- ◆ Children who exhibit behavior consistent with an abusive situation

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: PARENT CODE OF CONDUCT

POLICY NO.: 7

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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Play Academy requires the parents of enrolled children to always behave in a manner consistent with decency, courtesy, and respect. One of the goals of Play Academy is to provide the most appropriate environment in which a child can grow, learn, and develop. Achieving this ideal environment is the responsibility of the Play Academy employees and every parent or adult who enters the center. Parents are required to behave in a manner that fosters this ideal environment. Parents who violate the Parent Code of Conduct will not be permitted on agency property thereafter. Please refer to the Policy on Parent's Right to Immediate Access for additional information regarding the dis-enrollment of the child when a parent is prohibited from accessing agency property.

7.1 SWEARING/CURSING:

No parent or adult is permitted to curse or use other inappropriate language on agency property at any time, whether in the presence of a child or not. Such language is considered offensive by many people and will not be tolerated. If a parent or adult feels frustrated or angry, it is more appropriate to express frustration or anger using non-offensive language verbally. At NO time shall inappropriate language be directed toward members of the staff.

7.2 THREATENING OF EMPLOYEES, CHILDREN, OTHER PARENTS, OR ADULTS ASSOCIATED WITH PLAY ACADEMY:

Threats of any kind will not be tolerated. In today's society, Play Academy cannot afford to sit idly while threats are being made. In addition, all threats will be reported to the appropriate authorities and fully prosecuted by the law. While apologies for such behavior are appreciated, the agency will not assume the risk of a second chance. PARENTS MUST BE RESPONSIBLE FOR AND CONTROL OF THEIR BEHAVIOR AT ALL TIMES.

7.3 PHYSICAL/VERBAL PUNISHMENT OF YOUR CHILD OR OTHER CHILDREN AT PLAY ACADEMY:

While Play Academy does not necessarily support nor condone corporal punishment of children, such acts are not permitted in the childcare facility.

While verbal reprimands may be appropriate, it is not suitable for parents to verbally abuse their child. Doing so may cause undue embarrassment or emotional distress. Parents are always welcome to discuss a behavior issue with the teacher and to seek advice and guidance regarding appropriate and effective disciplinary procedures.

Parents are prohibited from addressing, for correction or discipline, a child that is not their own. Of course, no parent or other adult may physically punish another parent's child. Suppose a parent should witness another parent's child misbehaving or is concerned about behavior reported to them by their child. In that case, it is most appropriate for the parent to direct their concern to the classroom teacher and/or Center Director.

Furthermore, it is wholly inappropriate for one parent to seek out another parent to discuss their child's unacceptable behavior. All behavioral concerns should be brought to the classroom teacher or director. At that point, the teacher and/or director will address the issue with the other parent. Although you may be curious about the outcome of such a discussion, teachers and/or the Center Director are strictly prohibited from discussing anything about another child. All children enrolled in our agency have privacy rights and are further protected by our Confidentiality Policy. You may be assured that we will not discuss anything about your child with another parent or adult visiting the center.

7.4 SMOKING AND VAPING:

Smoking and vaping are prohibited anywhere on agency property for the health of all Play Academy employees, children, and associates. Parents are prohibited from smoking in the building, grounds, and Play Academy parking lot. Parents who smoke in their cars must dispose of cigarettes before entering the parking lot.

7.5 VIOLATIONS OF THE SAFETY POLICY:

Parents are required always to follow all safety procedures. These procedures are designed not as mere inconveniences but to protect the welfare and best interest of the employees, children, and associates of Play Academy. Please be particularly mindful of Play Academy entrance procedures. We all like to be polite. However, we must be careful not to allow unauthorized individuals into the center. Holding the door open for the person following you may be polite. However, that person may not be authorized to enter the premises. Security procedures are only as strong as the weakest person in our organizational chain. Be alert and mindful. Immediately report any breaches to the Center Director.

7.6 CONFRONTATIONAL INTERACTIONS WITH EMPLOYEES, OTHER PARENTS, OR ASSOCIATES OF THE PLAY ACADEMY:

While it is understood that parents will not always agree with the employees of Play Academy or the parents of the other children, it is expected that all disagreements be handled calmly and respectfully. Confrontational interactions are not an appropriate means of communicating a point and are strictly prohibited.

7.7 VIOLATIONS OF THE CONFIDENTIALITY POLICY:

Play Academy is responsible for maintaining the confidentiality of all persons associated with the agency. Parents must understand the implications of this responsibility. Parents need to recognize that the Confidentiality Policy applies not only to their child or family but also to all children, families, and employees associated with Play Academy. Any parent who shares confidential information or pressures employees or other parents for information that is unnecessary for them to know will be deemed to violate the Confidentiality Policy.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: PARENT'S RIGHT TO IMMEDIATE ACCESS

POLICY NO.: 8

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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As provided by law, parents of children in our care are entitled to immediate access, without prior notice, to their children whenever they are in care at Play Academy.

In cases where the child is subject to a court order (e.g., Custody Order, Restraining Order, or Protection from Abuse Order), Play Academy must be provided with a Certified Copy of the most recent order and all amendments. The court's orders will be strictly followed unless the custodial parent(s) requests a more liberal variation of the order in writing. In the case where both parents are afforded shared/joint custody by order of the court, both parents must sign the request for a more liberal interpretation of the order.

Without a court order on file with Play Academy, **both** parents will be afforded equal access to their child as stipulated by law. Play Academy cannot, without a court order, limit one parent's access by request of the other parent, regardless of the reason. Suppose a situation presents itself where one parent does not want the other parent to have access to their child. In that case, Play Academy suggests that the parent keep the child with them until a court order is issued since our rights to retain your child are secondary to the other parent's right to immediate access. Play Academy staff will contact the local police should a conflict arise.

Visitors are asked to schedule appointments with the Center Director and are allowed in the childcare facility only at the director's discretion. An employee of Play Academy will always accompany visitors throughout the center.

Play Academy will dismiss any child whose parent is prohibited from entering upon agency property. Due to the parents' right to immediate access policy and state and federal regulations, Play Academy cannot have a child at the agency when the child's parent is prohibited access. Play Academy will not agree to any request to maintain a child's enrollment even if the parent agrees to stay out of the center. Such an agreement violates the law and will not be entertained.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: DISMISSAL

POLICY NO.: 9

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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Play Academy reserves the right to dismiss any child at any time, with or without cause.

Parents will be refunded any unused tuition within two weeks of the dismissal. An agency check will be mailed to the address indicated in the children's file. Any past-due balance must be paid within 30 days of the dismissal. An invoice detailing the past-due balance will be forwarded to the address indicated in the children's file within one week of the dismissal. Any balance remaining after the 30 days will be referred to the agency's legal counsel for collection.

The administrators or designee will assist the parents in gathering their child's belongings at dismissal time. Parents are required to leave the agency property calmly and respectfully immediately. Play Academy will request assistance from local police should any parent become disruptive and/or uncooperative while gathering their child's belongings upon dismissal.

If a dismissed child and his/her parents wish to return to agency property following a dismissal, they must call and request an appointment with the center administrator. Appointments are made at the administrator's discretion and are not the right of the dismissed child or parent.

Following a dismissal, Play Academy will prosecute any parent or child who harasses, threatens, or in any manner causes harm to anyone affiliated with the agency by calling, writing, or any other means to the fullest extent of the law.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: WITHDRAW

POLICY NO.: 10

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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When withdrawing a child for any reason, two weeks' written notice is required. If the proper notice is given, any unused tuition will be refunded within thirty days of the withdrawal. Parents will be charged tuition for two additional weeks if the required notice is not given.

Following their last day of enrollment, the parents and child are not permitted to re-enter agency property without prior permission from the administrator. A withdrawn child and his/her parents must call and request an appointment with the administrator if they wish to return to the agency property following the last day of enrollment at Play Academy. Appointments are made at the administrator's discretion and are not exemplary of the withdrawn child or parent.

Parents who wish to change their child's days or times of enrollment at Play Academy must submit a request to do so two weeks in advance of the proposed change. The Administrator will notify the parents in writing if the new schedule is available. A schedule change will not be final until a new fee agreement is signed. If the requested schedule is not available, parents may choose to continue with the current schedule until the requested schedule becomes available or may choose to withdraw their child from the program. The date the request for the administrator receives the schedule change will be used to toll the two weeks' notice required for withdrawal.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: COURT ORDERS EFFECTING ENROLLED CHILDREN

POLICY NO.: 11

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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In cases where an enrolled child is subject to a court order (ex... Custody Order, Restraining Order, or Protection from Abuse Order), Play Academy must be provided with a Certified Copy of the most recent order and all amendments. The court orders will be strictly followed unless the custodial parent(s) requests a more liberal variation of the order in writing. In the case where both parents are afforded shared/joint custody by order of the court, both parents must sign the request for a more liberal interpretation of the order.

Without a court order on file with the Play Academy administration, both parents shall be afforded equal access to their child as stipulated by law. Play Academy cannot, without a court order, limit one parent's access by request of the other parent, regardless of the reason. If a situation presents itself where one parent does not want the other parent to have access to their child, Play Academy suggests that the parent keep the child with them until a court order is issued.

The most recently dated court order will be followed if conflicting court orders are presented.

Once presented with a Protection from Abuse Order or a Restraining Order, Play Academy must follow the order for the entire period it is in effect. Employees of Play Academy cannot, at the request of anyone except the issuing judge, allow a Protection from Abuse Order and/or a Restraining Order to be violated. Play Academy will report any violations of these orders to the court.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: ARRIVAL PROCEDURES

POLICY NO.: 12

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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Parents are encouraged to bring their children before 9 a.m.; if a child must be dropped off after 9:30 a.m., the teacher or administrator must be notified.

Upon arrival at Play Academy, the parents or the adult dropping the child off must sign the child into care at the Brightwheel kiosk in the reception area. Children must be escorted by their parents or adults, dropping them off at their designated classroom. Children are required by law to be constantly supervised while in the childcare facility. Parents must help children put away their outerwear and settle for the day.

Play Academy discourages parents from sneaking out of the center. Some children exhibit separation anxiety when it is time for their parents to leave. Play Academy believes parents should tell the anxious child upon arrival that after all the child's things are put away, the parent will kiss, hug, and say goodbye to the child. This will prepare the child for their departure. The employee present in the classroom will comfort and assist the child through the anxious time. Parents are asked to leave after saying goodbye. The longer the parent of an anxious child drags out the departure, the more anxiety the child is likely to feel. The professional employees of Play Academy are available to discuss other options if the child does not settle into the arrival routine after a reasonable time.

Parents must notify the child's teacher or administrator of any special instructions or needs for the child's day. The parent must present the special instructions in a letter or through Brightwheel message and verbally discuss them with the classroom teacher or administrator. These special instructions include but are not limited to Early Pick Up, Alternative Pick-Up Person, health issues over the previous night that need to be observed, and/or any general matters of concern of which the childcare providers should be aware best to meet the needs of your child throughout the day.

Play Academy provides breakfast from 7 a.m. until 8 a.m. Parents arriving after 8 am must feed their children a nutritious and filling breakfast before arriving at Play Academy. We do not allow outside food unless a child has a care plan.

12.1 NOTIFICATION OF ABSENCE

Parents must inform the center by 9:00 a.m. if a child will not be at the center on a scheduled day. This will enable the center to maintain appropriate ratios more

effectively and help the classroom teacher plan for the day effectively. Parents who fail to give proper notice of an absence on three occasions in one school calendar year will result in the child being dismissed from the program.

If your child is ill, we request that you notify the center administrator of their absence and symptoms. This enables our faculty to track any diseases at our school. This information will only be shared with staff on a "need-to-know" basis. If your child has a communicable disease, we ask that you share the diagnosis with the administrator so that the parents of the children in the school may be notified that a communicable disease is present. Once again, only the information on infectious diseases will be shared. Play Academy will take all measures necessary to protect your child's confidentiality. Parents are not required to disclose this information by law, and your continued enrollment will not be based on your decision to share (or not) the reason for your child's absence from school.

Parents who know their child will be late must notify the center by 9 a.m. to maintain the appropriate number of employees, number of prepared meals, and ratios when the child arrives at school.

12.2 AGENCY'S RIGHT TO REFUSE ADMISSION:

Play Academy reserves the right to refuse admission to any child at any time, with or without cause.

Play Academy strives to maintain an ample list of substitutes in anticipation of staff absences. However, there are times when substitutes are unavailable, and classrooms must be closed to comply with licensing regulations. Refusal will be based on a "first come, first served" basis when seeking to maintain appropriate staff-to-child ratios and/or when closing classrooms.

Possible reasons for the refusal of admission include but are not limited to:

1. Lack of staff to maintain appropriate Staff Child Ratios determined by State Licensing Regulations.
2. The need to maintain compliance with Licensing Regulations.
3. Staff deem the child too ill to attend.
4. Domestic Situations that present a safety risk to the child, staff, or other children enrolled at Play Academy if the child were to be present at the center.
5. Arriving after 9:30 am without notice.
6. Parents' failure to maintain accurate, up-to-date records.
7. Parents' failure to complete and return required documentation promptly.

Parents will not be reimbursed for days when their child is refused admission to the program

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: DEPARTURE PROCEDURES

POLICY NO.: 13

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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Parents or other authorized adults must sign their child out of care at the Brightwheel kiosk in the reception area. Once a parent signs their child out, they are solely responsible for supervising them while on agency premises. The parent may not allow a child to wander through the hallways, bathrooms, other classrooms, and/or playground. Parents must handle all business issues before signing out their child and directly exit the building after signing them out of care.

Parents must take home all papers in the child's cubby or school bag each day.

Parents or persons designated to act "in loco parentis" must sign any incident/accident reports from the day at pick-up. The classroom teacher will be able to briefly discuss the matter with you or other authorized adults at pick-up. However, should you feel it necessary to have an in-depth discussion or meeting, it is most appropriate to schedule the meeting later because the teacher is responsible for supervising the remaining children in the classroom. A telephone conference may be scheduled for later or the next day at nap/rest time if the parent(s) cannot meet at the center during the day.

13.1 LATE PICK-UP:

According to the kiosk's clock, a parent is late when a child is signed out at 6:30 p.m. or later. A late fee of \$1 per minute will be paid directly to the teacher at pick-up time.

A child's services will be terminated if the child is picked up late on three occasions in one school year, regardless of the reason for the late pick-up. The parents are responsible for ensuring that someone (either a parent or an emergency/alternate pick-up person) can pick up the child on time.

13.2 PERSONS APPEARING TO BE IMPAIRED BY DRUGS/ALCOHOL AT PICK-UP:

The staff of Play Academy will contact local police and/or the other custodial parent should a parent appear to the staff of Play Academy to be under the influence of drugs and/or alcohol. The parent's right to immediate access does not permit the agency to deny a custodial parent access to their child, even if

the parent is or appears impaired. However, Play Academy staff will delay the impaired parent as long as possible while contacting the other parent, the local police, and Child Protective Services.

Any other authorized person who attempts to pick up a child and appears to the staff of Play Academy to be under the influence of drugs and/or alcohol will be denied access to the child. The staff of Play Academy will contact the child's parents, local police, and Child Protective Services to notify them of the situation.

13.3 EMERGENCY/ALTERNATE PICK-UP FORMS:

At enrollment, parents will receive an Emergency/Alternate Pick-up form. Parents are encouraged to include on this form any persons who, in the course of events, may at one time be asked to pick up their child from Play Academy. In an emergency, the child's parents will be called first. If they cannot be reached, staff will contact the people listed on this form until someone can be reached.

Should the staff contact a parent who cannot pick up the child, the parent must arrange for someone on the emergency list to pick it up. Failure to make such arrangements will result in dismissal from the program.

Parents do not need to be listed on the Emergency Contact Form. The nature of the parental relationship affords the parents (in the absence of a court order indicating otherwise) the right to pick up their child. The people on the Emergency/Alternate Pick-Up Form can only pick up the child. Staff are not permitted to discuss the child's day with them.

Before the agency releases the child, the person on the Emergency/Alternate pick-up form must provide a government-issued photo ID.

All changes and/or additions to the Emergency/Alternate Pick-up form must be made in writing or updated on the Brightwheel app. Only custodial parents have the right to make changes or additions.

Play Academy reserves the right to refuse/ban any person listed on the Emergency/Alternate Contact Form for any reason, including but not limited to violations of the policies/procedures contained herein. The enrolling parent(s) is responsible for informing each person on the Emergency/Alternate Form of the policies/procedures.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: TRANSPORTATION

POLICY NO.: 14

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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Play Academy's top priority during transportation is child safety. We provide transportation for specific purposes, such as field trips, before- and after-care, and emergencies if necessary.

Drivers must have valid licenses, clean driving records, and pass background checks. Vehicles must be insured, regularly inspected, and equipped with first aid supplies.

Parents must provide written consent for transportation and sign permission slips for any field trips. Emergency services and parents will be contacted immediately in case of an accident.

Play Academy staff will call 911 for emergency transportation in case of a medical emergency. Play Academy will not provide childcare services to children whose parents refused to grant consent for transportation to the source of emergency treatment.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: CLOSING INFORMATION

POLICY NO.: 15

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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15.1 HOURS OF OPERATION:

Play Academy will be open Monday through Friday from 6:30 a.m. to 6:30 p.m. The center will be closed to observe the following holidays: Memorial Day, Fourth of July, Labor Day, Thanksgiving, and the day after, Christmas Day, and New Year's Day. If any of these holidays fall on Sunday, the following Monday will be considered the holiday. If any holidays fall on Saturday, the preceding Friday will be considered the holiday. We will close at 1:00 pm on Christmas and New Year's Eve.

15.2 EMERGENCY CLOSING AND INCLEMENT WEATHER:

In the event of an emergency closing and/or inclement weather, parents will be notified of the closing by Brightwheel message.

Should the school need to close in the middle of the day, the school staff will attempt to reach the child's parents first to arrange for pick up. Should the staff be unable to get the parents, the people listed on the emergency contact form will be called until pick-up arrangements can be made. Staff will notify the parents or emergency contact person at the time of the call of the pickup location should the children need to be evacuated from the childcare center. Parents or emergency contacts should report directly to the alternate location if one is indicted.

Should the center need to close, tuition will not be refunded or reduced for closures of less than 20 school days per calendar year.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: CURRICULUM INFORMATION

POLICY NO.: 16

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 10/10/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 10/10/2025

Play Academy uses a High-Scope curriculum that balances teacher-directed and child-directed daily activities. The curriculum is aligned with Ohio Early Learning and Development Standards. Our teachers aim to make learning fun and help prepare your child for the future.

16.1 SCREENING AND ASSESSMENTS:

- Play Academy uses ASQ-3 and ASQ/SE-2 to screen children for developmental delays between one month and 5½ years of age. The ASQ screenings are completed within 60 days of enrollment and annually thereafter. The results are shared and discussed with parents during parent-teacher conferences. The program reports required screening and assessment data information to the Ohio Department of Child and Youth (DCY).

Play Academy also assesses all children ages 6 weeks through 5 years through anecdotal notes submitted weekly through OnlineCOR. These assessments are obtained through observation and daily interactions with the children. Parents are also provided with a weekly email of the observation/notes entered for their children from the teachers under their assessment page for that week.

16.2 STAFF AND RATIOS:

Play Academy maximum group sizes:

1:5, 2:10	Infants (6 weeks-12 months)
1:6, 2:12	Young toddlers (12 months-18 months)
1:7, 2:14	Older Toddlers (18 months-30 months)
1:8, 2:16	Toddlers (30 months to 36 months)
1:11, 2:22	3-4 years old
1:13, 2:26	4-5 years old
1:17, 2:34	School-age children

16.3 DAILY SCHEDULES:

The children's daily schedule is flexible enough to provide adaptability when necessary but structured enough to provide predictability for the children. We want them to view their school as a safe and comforting place where they know what to expect and when to expect it. Naptime is typically 2 hours, from 12-2 pm/1-3 pm, depending on the classroom schedule. Children are encouraged to bring a soft toy from home or a blanket for comfort. The children who do not nap are expected to rest on a cot and be provided with a quiet toy/book. Children 12 months and under will have a daily schedule based on individual needs/wants.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: GUIDANCE AND SUPERVISION

POLICY NO.: 17

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 10/10/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 10/10/2025

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17.1 SUPERVISION OF INFANTS, TODDLERS, AND PRESCHOOLERS:

At no time will a child be left unattended. Staff will always supervise children, including nap time. If a child becomes ill, they may be isolated in a section of the room not in use but within sight and hearing of a staff member.

17.2 SUPERVISION OF SCHOOL-AGE CHILDREN:

School-age children may run errands inside the building or use the restroom alone or in groups of no more than six children without adult supervision as long as the following conditions are met: children are within hearing distance of their teacher, and the teacher checks on the children regularly until they return. One group of no more than six schoolchildren, the fourth-grade age or older, may engage in activities that pose no physical risk to their safety in a room without a childcare staff member as long as the teacher can see or hear the child at all times and checks on the children periodically. Play Academy will operate a full-day program for school-agers for vacations, delays, or cancellations when school is closed.

17.3 CHILDREN ARRIVING AT THE CENTER FROM OTHER PROGRAMS:

At times, it may be necessary for a child to arrive at the center from another program (for example, A child arrives after another part-time program or a school-ager arrives at the center after school). If a child is scheduled to come but does not, we will first contact the parent to confirm that the child is expected to be at the center that day and then contact the program from which they are to have arrived. We will then consult with the parents to determine further action. For this reason, parents must contact the center when their child is not attending.

17.4 CHALLENGING BEHAVIOR:

If a child is displaying a challenging behavior, staff will:
Properly assess the child. Explain and refer the child to the Technical Assistance Program. Parents will permit the TA to come in and observe the child, develop a plan, and reinforce the strategies given.

If a parent refuses Technical Assistance or suggestions from Play Academy and the challenging behavior continues, the center can dismiss the child at any time.

When a child's behavior places themselves or others at risk, the program will communicate and implement a behavior plan. If the behavior does not improve or the plan cannot be successfully modified, the child may be subject to suspension or dismissal from the program.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: MEALS AND SNACKS

POLICY NO.: 18

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

Play Academy is a sponsor of the CACFP or USDA food program. We ensure that our meals are well-balanced and use many fresh ingredients in the meals we cook at our center. We follow the USDA guidelines when cooking and serving our meals daily. The meals will be posted weekly on our bulletin board, and copies will be available at the front desk and online at www.playacademyusa.com.

Play Academy will provide nutritious, healthy meals and snacks for all the children that are included in the price of the tuition:

Breakfast: 7:00-8:00 am

Morning Snack: 9:00-9:30 am

Lunch: 11:15 am-12:30 pm

Supper: 3:00 - 4:00 pm

The lunches will meet all childcare licensing requirements. The content of meals, snacks, and breakfast shall be selected from the following four basic food groups: 1. Meat or meat alternative 2. Breads and grains 3. Fruits and vegetables 4. Milk (fluid cow's milk) and dairy a) 100% whole homogenized vitamin D fortified for children 12 to 24 months b) 1% or skim homogenized vitamin A and D fortified for children over 24 months. Please let us know ahead of time if your child is not permitted to have any types of food due to allergies or religious beliefs. We do not allow any outside food unless substitution is needed. If your child requires a food supplement or a modified diet, a care plan will be created to ensure the portions and nutritional requirements for meals and snacks described in Appendix B 5101:2-12-22 are followed.

We make drinking water available so children can serve themselves inside and outside. Staff may only drink water during children's snacks and mealtimes.

Under Federal civil rights law and U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA) civil rights regulations and policies, the USDA, its Agencies, offices, employees, and institutions participating in or administering USDA programs are prohibited from discriminating based on race, color, national origin, sex, disability, age, or reprisal or retaliation for prior civil rights activity in any program or activity conducted or funded by USDA. Persons with disabilities who require alternative means of

communication for program information (e.g., Braille, large print, audiotape, American Sign Language, etc.) should contact the Agency (State or local) where they applied for benefits. Individuals who are deaf, hard of hearing, or have speech disabilities may contact USDA through the Federal Relay Service at (800) 877-8339. Additionally, program information may be made available in languages other than English. To file a program complaint of discrimination, complete the USDA Program Discrimination Complaint Form (AD-3027) found online at http://www.ascr.usda.gov/complaint_filing_cust.html and at any USDA office or write a letter addressed to USDA and provide in the letter all of the information requested in the form. To request a copy of the complaint form, call (866) 632-9992. Submit your completed form or letter to USDA by: (1) mail: U.S. Department of Agriculture Office of the Assistant Secretary for Civil Rights 1400 Independence Avenue, SW Washington, D.C. 20250-9410; (2) fax: (202) 690-7442; or (3) email: program.intake@usda.gov. This institution is an equal opportunity provider.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: INFANT CARE

POLICY NO.: 19

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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Breastfeeding mothers are welcome to come to the center daily to feed their children or to pump. Appropriate, private feeding locations will be made available. Please discuss your desire to come to the center to breastfeed your child with the classroom teacher.

We change infants' and toddlers' diapers every 2 hours or when soiled between the 2-hour schedule. Parents who disagree with this arrangement should inform an administrator and note the enrollment paperwork.

The parents must label food and formula brought in daily with the name and date. If breast milk is provided, the name, date, and date expressed must be on the label.

Play Academy will provide Similac 360 Total and mix it with boiled water according to the manufacturer's instructions.

If your child uses a different kind, you can bring your own in an original container and clean-labeled bottles or already-prepared formula in bottles. Be sure to prepare one more bottle than you think your child will consume in a day to ensure your child won't run out. Prepared bottles must be stored in the designated refrigerator and warmed in a water bath before feeding. No bottles will be microwaved. The parents must take all bottles home each night to be washed.

Staff will complete a daily chart for each child detailing food intake, sleeping patterns, diaper changes, and activities.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: OUTDOOR PLAY

POLICY NO.: 20

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

Research shows that children are healthier when they engage in daily outdoor play. Based on this information and state requirements, our program will include outdoor play daily.

Children will not be taken outside when the wind chill drops below 25 degrees Fahrenheit or the heat index above 90 degrees Fahrenheit. If the situation requires it, we will adjust outdoor time due to rain, threatening weather, ozone warning, air quality, etc. We will include time for indoor gross motor activities whenever children cannot go outside.

Please send your children with the proper clothing so they might be comfortable and safe whenever we are outside. This includes snow pants, hats, mittens, and boots in the wintertime. Do not forget to apply sunscreen in the morning (May through September). Closed-toed shoes are required for safe outdoor play.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: TOYS FROM HOME

POLICY NO.: 21

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

Due to the risk of damage, sharing issues, and loss, children are not permitted to bring in toys from home unless specifically requested by the classroom teacher for use as part of the curriculum. Parents are responsible for enforcing this policy with their children and are encouraged to consult the classroom teacher if their child is struggling with it.

If the parents repeatedly fail to enforce this policy with their children, the staff will call the parents and require them to come to the school and remove the toy.

Children in classrooms with nap/rest time are permitted to include, with their bedding supplies, one plush/non-musical toy with which to nap/rest. This toy is to be placed with the bedding supplies and will only be allowed at nap/rest time.

All toys brought in for use as part of the curriculum and/or for nap/rest time will be inspected by Play Academy staff for safety and appropriateness and may be prohibited at the sole discretion of Play Academy.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: DRESS CODE

POLICY NO.: 22

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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Clothing:

Children are engaged in various activities during the day, some of which can be messy and/or athletic. Additionally, children are engaged in outdoor play daily, weather permitting. Due to these activities, children must be dressed in seasonably appropriate, comfortable clothing.

Parents are prohibited from dressing children in overalls or clothing with difficult closures, as these types of clothing present challenges for children when toileting.

Coats, hats, gloves, scarves, and winter boots must be provided in winter. The children do not need to wear their winter boots to school; teachers will change them when they go outdoors.

Children are not permitted to wear open-toed and/or open-backed shoes. Rubber-soled sneakers or tennis shoes are the most appropriate shoes for school activities.

Children ages 3 through 5 must always have one seasonably and size-appropriate complete change of clothing at the center. Children under 3 years of age must always have two seasonably and size-appropriate complete clothing changes at the center. A complete change of clothing includes a shirt, pants, underwear, socks, and shoes. Teachers will post reminders for parents to update their clothing as the weather begins to change.

All clothing must be labeled with the child's first and last name. This includes coats, hats, gloves, scarves, and boots. Play Academy is not responsible for lost or damaged clothing.

Jewelry/Accessories:

Children are not permitted to wear jewelry and accessories except mall studs, which are not easily removed. This is a safety hazard for your child and the other children in the program.

Play Academy is not responsible for damage to or loss of articles of clothing or valuables.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: PARENT PARTICIPATION/VOLUNTEERS

POLICY NO.: 23

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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We believe parents are the most significant adults in a child's life. We encourage families to participate in the activities at the center whenever possible. Each year, we provide parent-teacher conferences and other events for families. We encourage all families to participate. Teachers are available to discuss children's progress or needs at any time; however, due to staff responsibilities and schedules, parents are asked to make appointments with staff when necessary to engage in any lengthy conversation. Teachers want to be able to focus on their children at that time.

Parents are invited and encouraged to be involved in their child's school activities. There are many ways in which parents can participate and volunteer at the childcare center. Parents may volunteer to attend trips, read in the classroom, assist teachers, and/or coordinate special events. Teachers will have posted any available volunteer opportunities in their classrooms. Parents not interested in volunteering directly at the school may donate items or do maintenance work.

Any parent who regularly volunteers in the classroom must secure all criminal background checks, as our licensing regulations require. Any person, including parents, with felony convictions, sex offender convictions, and/or open investigations into criminal activities will not be permitted to volunteer in the classroom or on field trips.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: CARING FOR CHILDREN WITH SPECIAL NEEDS

POLICY NO.: 24

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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Children with special needs will be accepted into our program under the guidelines of the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA). Children with special needs will be given the opportunity to participate in the program to the fullest extent possible. To accomplish this, Play Academy staff may consult with agencies/organizations as needed, provided parental permission is granted (Authorization for Release of Information form). Play Academy will provide reasonable accommodation, including allowing outside therapists into the program to provide support, therapy, and interventions for children with IEPs/IFSPs.

The administrator will ensure that when a child with a special need is identified on the Child Care Enrollment Form, the family will be given a "Child Medical/ Physical Care Plan for Child Care" form to be filled out by the family and health care provider collaboratively with a childcare program staff member. All staff will receive general training on the benefits of including children with special needs and training in specific accommodations that any child in their classroom may need. The knowledge of parents and health care professionals caring for the child with special needs will be consulted to determine accommodation and/or therapy requirements. The center can dismiss children who display dangerous behaviors to themselves and others.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: HEALTH AND SAFETY

POLICY NO.: 25

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 10/10/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 10/10/2025

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25.1 PRE-ENROLLMENT REQUIREMENTS:

Each child is required to complete a pre-enrollment packet of information. This packet will be returned to the center's office before the child's first day of attendance. All children must have a complete date immunization record at Play Academy. This is per our licensing regulations. If you have not immunized your child, the waiver at the bottom of the Child Medical Statement needs to be signed by a parent. Parents will be notified of a communicable disease in the center.

To attend Play Academy, all children must have a Medical Statement filled out by a licensed medical professional. The Form must indicate the child's fitness to attend Play Academy, be completed by a licensed healthcare professional, and be returned within the first two weeks of enrollment.

25.2 CHILDREN WITH SEVERE ALLERGIES:

For your child's safety, parents must provide a signed copy of the "Child Medical/ Physical Care Plan For Child Care" form detailing any allergies, food or otherwise, from which their child suffers at enrollment or when the allergy is discovered. This form must be filled out by the child's physician, parent (s), or legal guardian(s) and updated annually or more frequently, as needed. In addition to this form, parents must provide a copy of any additional physician's orders and procedural guidelines relating to preventing and treating the child's allergy.

Parents must also execute a "Release and Waiver of Liability for Administering Emergency Treatment to Children with Severe Allergies" form. This form releases Play Academy from liability for administering treatment to children with severe allergies and taking other necessary actions outlined in the "Child Medical/ Physical Care Plan For Child Care" form, provided Play Academy exercises reasonable care in taking such actions.

Any medication required to treat an allergic reaction must be provided following the Medication Policy detailed herein.

25.3 COMMUNICABLE DISEASES:

Play Academy follows all health/communicable disease policies outlined in the Ohio Department of Health Communicable Disease Chart, which is posted in the office area.

Parents are required to pick up an ill child by phone within 1 hour of notification. If a parent is reached but cannot pick their child up within 1 hour, it becomes the parent's responsibility to arrange an alternate pick-up with someone listed on the child's emergency contact form. The staff will not continue to call those listed on the emergency contact list once a parent is reached. If a parent cannot be reached, the staff will call the people listed on the emergency contact form until arrangements can be made for the child to be picked up.

A child with any of the following symptoms will be immediately isolated and discharged to the parent or emergency contact:

- Temperature of 101 degrees Fahrenheit (100 if taken under the arm) in combination with any other signs or symptoms of illness.

Children excluded from the program due to a fever may not return to the program until they are fever-free, without fever-reducing medication, for 24 hours. If your child is sent home due to a fever, he/she is not permitted to return to the program the following day at a minimum.

- Diarrhea (more than three abnormally loose stools within 24 hours). Children may return to the program when regular bowel movements resume.

- Severe coughing (causing the child to become red or blue in the face or to make a whooping sound).

- Difficult or rapid breathing.

- Yellowish skin or eyes.

- Redness of the eye or eyelid, thick and purulent (pus) eye discharge, matted eyelashes, burning, itching, or eye pain.

- Untreated infected skin patches, unusual spots, or rashes.

- Unusually dark urine or grey or white stools.

- Stiff neck with an elevated temperature.

- Evidence of untreated lice, scabies, or other parasitic infestations.

- Sore throat or difficulty in swallowing.

- Vomiting more than once or when accompanied by any other sign or symptom of illness.

Children will be excluded from participating in the program if they exhibit symptoms of any communicable disease. They will not be permitted to return until they are no longer contagious. Children must present a doctor's note stating they are no longer contagious and can return to the program. Play

Academy reserves the right to refuse to allow a child to return if the center director or designee believes the child to be too ill to participate in the program.

If your child is absent due to illness, we request that you notify the center administrator. This enables our faculty to track any diseases at our school. This information will only be shared with faculty on a "need-to-know" basis. If your child has a communicable disease, we ask that you share the diagnosis with the center administrator so that the parents of the children in the school may be notified that an infectious disease is present. Once again, only the information on communicable diseases will be shared. Play Academy will take all measures necessary to protect your child's confidentiality. You are not required to disclose this information by law, and your continued enrollment will not be based on your decision to share (or not) the reason for your child's absence from school.

25.4 BITING:

Play Academy recognizes that biting is a developmentally appropriate behavior for children in infants through 2 ½-year-old classrooms. Parents with children in these classrooms should expect that their children may be bitten or will bite another child. The staff understands that parents are concerned and can be upset when their child is involved in a biting incident. We ask that you remember this is a developmentally appropriate behavior and that the staff is working to identify situations that provoke or elicit this behavior so it can be prevented in the future. The staff will not punish or harshly discipline children in the younger classrooms for biting behavior; they will redirect them to different activities in separate classroom areas. Parents must work with staff to identify methods and strategies to curb this behavior. Uncooperative parents will have their child's services terminated.

Children older than three may occasionally be involved in a biting incident. For children in this age group who bite, the staff will use the discipline procedures outlined in the discipline section of this handbook and observe the child to determine what provokes or elicits this inappropriate behavior. Parents must cooperate with staff to help their child control this behavior. Uncooperative parents will have their child's service terminated. Furthermore, children in the older age groups who bite 3 times in a school year will have their services terminated since the safety of all the children in the program is of the utmost concern to Play Academy.

The incident/accident report will be provided to notify parents that a biting incident occurred during the day. The staff may not discuss with either parent the identity of the other child involved in the incident. This information is confidential and cannot be disclosed. The staff of the Play Academy cannot

discuss the medical history of any child involved in a biting incident with the other party. It is recommended that any child involved in a biting incident be seen by their family physician if the parents are concerned about communicable diseases possibly resulting from the biting incident.

25.5 DISPENSING MEDICATION:

Play Academy will only dispense over-the-counter and/or prescription medication in original, labeled containers accompanied by a doctor's note with explicit dosage and administration instructions. Play Academy will only give medication to the child for whom the doctor's note is written and for whom the medication container is labeled. Parents must complete an "Administration of Medication" form. The form and medication are to be turned in to the administrator. Medications will be stored in a designated area inaccessible to children. Medications may not be stored in the child's cubbies or book bags. School-age children are not permitted to carry their own medications or ointments.

Play Academy will dispense over-the-counter, fever-reducing/pain medication (ex., Children's Tylenol, Children's Motrin) on an as-needed basis, with a doctor's note detailing the recommended reasons for administration and appropriate dosage. Before administering fever-reducing/pain medication, staff will contact a parent or person listed on the emergency contact form if a parent cannot be reached to inform them of our need to administer the medication. Staff will also notify the parents or emergency contact person if the child must be picked up due to illness. Refer to the policy listed above regarding picking up ill children.

Parents are responsible for ensuring that all prescription medication is appropriately labeled by a pharmacist and replaced before its expiration date.

25.6 FIRE/EMERGENCY DRILLS:

Play Academy conducts monthly fire and emergency/evacuation drills. Parents, staff, and children are not informed of drill dates or times, as this is the most effective way to assess the effectiveness of fire and emergency/evacuation plans.

Parents may not sign children into or out of the program during a fire/emergency drill, real fire, or other emergencies. They must wait until the drill is complete and the children have returned to the building to sign their child into the program. Parents may feel free to stay with the child's class in the designated safe zone outside the building until the drill is complete.

In a real fire or other emergency, the administrator or designate will inform each classroom teacher that the school will close. At this time, any parents waiting to

sign their child in will have to leave the premises with their child. All other parents or emergency contact people will be notified by telephone. As with the sick child pick-up policy, children must be picked up within 1 hour of the telephone call.

Parents wishing to sign their child out of the program during a fire/emergency drill or actual fire or other emergency are expected to have patience with the staff as they try to maintain order during an often hectic and dangerous situation. If the center is amid a fire/emergency drill, parents must wait until the drill is completed and the staff and children are returned to the building to sign their child out of the program. Suppose the center has an actual fire/emergency. In that case, parents will be asked to wait until the administrator or designee has accounted for all staff and children and gives the staff permission to release children. Once again, parents and staff need to work together, remain calm, and cooperate with the fire/emergency personnel and center administration during these critical situations.

Should the administration of Play Academy or any emergency services personnel determine that the building is too dangerous to be occupied, the staff and children will be taken to an alternate location. Once the children are assembled here, the staff will contact parents or emergency contact people to pick them up. Children must be picked up within one hour of the telephone call.

25.7 INCIDENT/ACCIDENT REPORTS:

In the case of a minor incident/injury, staff will administer basic first aid and TLC. If the injury/illness were more serious, first aid would be administered, and the parents would be contacted immediately to assist in deciding an appropriate course of action. If any injury/illness is life-threatening, the EMS will be contacted, parents will be notified, and staff members will accompany the child to the hospital with all available health records. Staff may not transport children in their vehicles. Only parents or EMS will transport children.

Should your child be involved in an incident or accident during the school day, a staff member will complete an Incident/accident Report. Parents must sign any incident/accident reports from the day at pick-up. The classroom teacher will be able to discuss the matter with you at pick-up briefly. However, should you feel it necessary to have an in-depth discussion or meeting, it is most appropriate to schedule the meeting later because the teacher is responsible for supervising the remaining children in the classroom. A telephone conference may be scheduled for the next day at nap/rest time if the parents cannot meet at the center during the day.

25.8 PEANUT FREE CENTER:

Due to the extreme nature of allergic reactions to Peanuts and products containing peanuts in some children, Play Academy prohibits peanuts and/or foods containing peanut products on Play Academy property and/or at Play Academy-sponsored events. These peanut allergies can be so severe that exposure to peanuts can result in an anaphylactic reaction. An allergic child can react simply by smelling peanuts on someone's breath or touching peanut oil residue left on a countertop, not only from consuming peanuts or peanut products.

Due to the possibility of cross-contamination (this occurs when one food is prepared with items previously used to prepare foods with peanuts or peanut products), Play Academy does not allow homemade snacks at the center. All snacks for birthdays and holidays must have the manufacturer's label with the ingredients. We must be mindful of the safety of all children enrolled at Play Academy.

Since Play Academy is a peanut-free environment, parents can purchase the items to make homemade snacks and arrange with the classroom teacher to make the snacks as part of a classroom lesson. Only Play Academy utensils, bowls, and bakeware may be used to prepare these foods.

25.9 FIREARMS AND WEAPONS:

No person is permitted to carry any Firearm, Ammunition, or Weapon on agency property for any reason. Violation of this policy will result in immediate dismissal from the program.

25.10 WATER ACTIVITIES:

Swimming pools are not allowed on Play Academy premises. However, some water activities, such as sprinklers or bubble parties, may be provided during summer.

Written parental permission will be obtained for any field trip to swimming pools.

PLAY ACADEMY Parma Heights

POLICY: PROBLEM/ISSUES RESOLUTIONS

POLICY NO.: 26

APPROVED BY: Tatiana Kogan

EFFECTIVE DATE: 1/1/2025

ADMINISTRATOR: Cynthia Patsko

DATE: 3/1/2025

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If you have any concerns or questions, please talk to the following staff members: the child's teacher, the lead teacher, and the administrator.

Please feel free to bring concerns up when they occur. Often, they can be addressed when there are little problems before they grow into more significant ones. Our staff fully realizes that you trust us with your little ones, and we want our relationship to be good.

Parents are always welcome to Play Academy. We believe we can partner to inspire your child's love of learning.

I/We _____, the parent(s)/legal guardian(s) of _____, acknowledge that I/We have received a copy of Play Academy's Parent Handbook and have been allowed to read the manual and ask questions about and understand the policies. Furthermore, I/We agree to abide by the guidelines outlined in the manual.

I/We understand that the policies described in the Parent Handbook are not conditions of enrollment, and the language does not create a contract between Play Academy and the parents. Play Academy reserves the right to alter, amend, or otherwise modify these guidelines, in its sole discretion, without prior notice.

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Print Name: _____

Signature: _____

Date: _____

Print Name: _____

Parent Handbook — Addendum: Electronic Records

Play Academy · read-only reference. You acknowledge this on the Parent Handbook Receipt, with your signature — not here.

Electronic records at Play Academy

Play Academy keeps an electronic record of your child's every day. The SafePass system records the exact moment your child is picked up and the exact moment they are returned to you, ensuring that only authorized adults can pick them up. We do this for one reason: your child's safety. This same record also serves as the basis for our nutrition program and government reporting, so what your family signs once fulfills all requirements without additional paperwork.

You don't need to do anything other than what you already do at the entrance: your phone is your key, and a printed card works the same way. Any entry in your child's file can be shown to you — just ask at the front desk.